

task you had to accomplish—something that scared the crap out of you and that you thought was impossible. Do you remember how intimidating that task was on day one? For me, it was writing my first book. I had never done it before, and the thought of writing one hundred thousand words (that actually made sense) stressed me out. But I got to work. I knocked out the first chapter, then the second. I kept plodding through it, working with the team that had come around me. Within a few months, I had a finished manuscript. The “impossible” task was done. I had tamed the monster. From that point on and for the rest of my life, I know that I’m capable of writing a book—because I’ve done it. That sense of self-confidence is one of my favorite benefits of hard work.

Fifth, hard work makes an impact on your career. This fifth benefit seems like a no-brainer, but don’t overlook it. Working hard isn’t just about doing your job. It’s more than your paycheck; it’s also about where you are, the work you’re doing, what you’re contributing, who you’re doing it with, and the greater mission you’re helping your company accomplish. You’re showing who you are, what you have to offer, and whether or not the people around you can trust you to do what you say you’re going to do. Remember, 96% of millionaires said they enjoyed what they did for a career, and 99% said the people around them would describe them as a hard worker. When you work hard at a job you enjoy, you unlock all kinds of potential in yourself. That makes you better not just at work, but in every other part of your life, too.

When it comes to your career, you want to strive to become the type of person Patrick Lencioni describes in his book *The Ideal Team Player*: someone who is hungry (a motivated go-getter), humble (knows who they are and what they bring to the table), and smart (expertly manages relationships). Isn’t that the kind of person you want to work with? Isn’t that who you’d want to hire onto your team? These are the kind of men and women who make a huge impact in the workplace. They get their own work done with excellence, and more impressively, they bring up the game of everyone around them. That’s the power of a strong work ethic.

Sixth, as Lencioni noted, hard work builds humility. When you spend years working toward a goal, you understand at a deep level how hard it is and what it takes to achieve something big. You probably also experience enough failure along the way that you lose any arrogance you may have had